FOUNDING ISSUE // ZERO

MIDAAN

Independent Intellectual & Cultural Review

ENTIHAB

Documenting the street narrative, the conflict of earth and sky, and the immortal testaments.

Amman • Palestine • Free Press & Wearable Advocacy

MIDAAN ARCHIVE // 2026

PROLOGUE

The Founding Manifesto: Entihab (Lamentation)

In this Midaan (arena), we do not write elegies; we document the pulse that refuses to die.

"Entihab" (Lamentation) is not a surrender to defeat; it is a solemn stand in the presence of blood, and absolute reverence for the martyrs and free spirits who turned their bodies into bridges upon which we cross toward survival. Grief here is not submission; it is wrath being sharpened, and memory that defies oblivion.

They thought the arenas were emptied, but "Midaan" has never been vacated, nor shall it ever be. As long as resistance remains an idea, and ideas cannot be assassinated, the battle continues—inherited across generations until the hour of liberation.

Today we launch "Midaan" as an artistic and cultural trench wherein we guard the narrative and weave from the pain of loss a banner that never falters. We take fuel from sorrow, weapons from the word, and barricades from art behind which we stand to defend our identity.

> This is "Issue Zero".. our silent cry, and our covenant inscribed with the agony of the land. Reflect deeply upon this lamentation, read between the lines of loss.. and prepare, for behind this heavy silence lies a coming storm that shall be written in Issue One.

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Archival Scope Note: This complete archival publication of Issue Zero compiles the four foundational texts verified against the original Midaan archives. The "Entihab - Issue One" dossier in the source archives represents the forthcoming companion publication and maintains a distinct issue boundary.

Conflict of Earth and Sky

Why the Palestine Cause Cannot Be Understood Apart from Creed

By: Midaan Editorial Collective · Published: October 2026

At cold diplomatic tables, politicians converse in the dialect of metrics, surface acreage, demographic density, and secure perimeter borders. They operate under the illusion that pen, paper, and colored cartography suffice to partition the soil and conclude decades of struggle. Yet upon the earth itself—where blood is spilled, ancestral dwellings are leveled, and prayers resonate under the roar of artillery—reality speaks a completely different tongue; one that recognizes neither the cartography of diplomacy, but rather the "geography of creed".

The gravest error committed by detached observers is the reduction of the Palestinian-Israeli struggle into a standard territorial dispute or political friction over state apparatus and natural resources. The reality is incomparably deeper and profoundly rooted: an existential clash wherein scriptural verses intersect with infantry rifles, and the oral traditions of prophets intermingle with resolutions of the United Nations.

> "It is an existential struggle wherein scriptural verses intersect with infantry rifles, disregarding synthetic diplomacy."

The Torah as a Colonial Roadmap.. Creed in the Service of Settlement

To comprehend the core of this struggle, one must examine how the Zionist movement operationalized "creed" as an instrument of settler-colonial dispossession. Although Zionism's founding figures were avowed secularists, they recognized early on that their project could never achieve mobilization without spiritual fervor.

Immigrants did not journey from the far corners of the earth merely to establish a liberal democracy; they arrived impelled by the narrative of the "Promised Land" and the construct of the "Chosen People". Scriptural passages were transformed in their hands from liturgical devotions into real estate deeds, and from spiritual prayers into tactical military mandates commanding the clearance of the land and the substitution of indigenous inhabitants with settlers.

"A Verse in a Book".. Roots in Collective Consciousness

Conversely, one cannot fathom legendary Palestinian steadfastness (Sumud) without decoding the creedal engine that sustains it. For the Palestinian—and the Arab and Muslim behind them—Palestine is not an exchangeable tract of soil compensable elsewhere. It is not merely a modern nation-state construct, but an indelible verse in the Quran.

The bond is non-negotiable and anchored upon two immovable pillars: First, the Creed of the Night Journey and Ascension (Al-Isra' wal-Mi'raj), where Al-Aqsa Mosque is not a stone structure, but the gateway of earth to heaven, the second sanctuary established, and Islam's first Qibla. Second, the Creed of Ribat (Vigilance on the Frontier), wherein dwelling upon this land is revered as permanent spiritual guard over the frontiers of truth, transforming physical presence into sanctified worship.

Analytical Comparison: Dimensions of the Conflict

Analytical Dimension	Traditional Political View	True Creedal Reality
Nature of Conflict	Dispute over borders, resources, and geography	Existential clash touching identity, scripture, and heritage
Mechanisms of Resolution	Negotiation tables, accords, and compromises	Adherence to indivisible historic and religious rights
Engine of Steadfastness	Civic rights and sovereignty under global law	Spiritual certainty, frontier vigil (Ribat), and sacred duty

Demise of "Pragmatism" & Battle of Narratives

The crux lies in the impossibility of dissolving theological conviction through political negotiation. A diplomat might concede territory in exchange for guarantees; but how does a people surrender sanctities interwoven into the marrow of human identity?

Simultaneously, Israel drifts relentlessly toward religious extremism; religious Zionism commands cabinets and dictates military actions based on exclusionary prophecies, extinguishing all hopes in superficial pragmatic compromises.

The Palestinian struggle against colonial occupation is first and foremost a battle of memory, identity, and narrative before it is an exchange of gunfire. While settler colonialism twists history to manufacture synthetic legitimacy, the Palestinian narrative stands deep-rooted like ancient olive trees, deriving its endurance from an unwavering conviction: that truth does not lapse through time, and that the earth ultimately speaks the language of its indigenous sons.

I Will Die Before Forty

By: Midaan Voice • Published: October 2026

I am now thirty-one years old. Just nine years separate me from forty, and from the inevitable expiration of my soul if it persists in trying to survive inside this programmed matrix. I no longer fear biological cessation; I fear the slow death—the death of passion, the death of inquiry, and the extinction of the self within a gargantuan apparatus that swallowed us whole from our first cry. A machine they designate.. 'The System'.

The System: The Great Matrix

I was born only to find myself entangled in an intricate web of interlocking systems. Pre-fabricated molds into which you have no choice but to be squeezed so you may be granted the stamp of 'Approval'. I never understood this system, and it never understood me. Within it, I am merely an anomaly in the code (a Glitch), a cog that refuses to turn with the rest because it clearly sees the abyss toward which they are heading.

The Patriarchal System: Deeds of Ownership

Domestication commenced at home. The patriarchal order was never a sanctuary or a compass; it was a rigid hierarchy intolerant of dialogue. They treated us as financial investments or extensions of their own deficits, never as sovereign souls. 'Do this because I am elder', 'Pursue this path because it elevates the family name'.

I never comprehended how affection is translated into conditional terms, or how blind compliance became the sole metric of filial piety. They foreclosed my identity before I could discover it, decreeing that this was 'respect'.

> "They never instructed us on how to question, only how to echo. The apparatus was calibrated to sever the wings of imagination."

The Educational System: Guillotine of Intellect

Then they consigned me to the educational system.. the manufacturing plant of identical replicas. There, I was instructed in the foundational lessons of hypocrisy: how to memorize what you reject in order to pass examinations that measure nothing beyond your capacity for subservience.

The apparatus was calibrated to sever the wings of imagination, execute critical thinking, and convert us into obedient laborers suited for the corporate marketplace. Whoever deviated from the syllabus, whoever dared ask 'Why?', was penalized and categorized as defective.

The Societal System: Theatre of the Absurd

I emerged onto the streets to collide with the social establishment.. an absurd theater populated by virtuosos of masked performance. A society consumed by superficial veneers, canonizing consumerism and measuring human dignity by automotive brand and bank balance.

They drafted the standard catalogue: graduate, get employed, mortgage your existence to financial lenders, marry to appease communal conventions, and procreate to feed new flesh into the identical meat-grinder. Hypocrisy here is no malfunction; it is the lubricating oil that keeps the machine spinning. The genuine soul is ostracized; the deviant is hunted as an existential hazard to the sedated herd.

The Theological System: The Prohibited Interrogations

Here we reach the ultimate labyrinth.. the apex of the pyramid invoked to sanctify everything prior: the divine apparatus as exported to us. I never accepted the distorted portrait of divinity they purveyed: a vengeful, vigilant sovereign transacting with humanity through crude commercial balance sheets of reward and retribution.

Inside me resides a longing for something infinitely greater, a cosmic presence, a peace unadulterated and unconditional. Yet their texts and doctrines converted faith into an instrument of domination, an armed watchtower suppressing thought and outlawing wonder. They seek not your communion with the Divine, but your submission to the version they tailored to legitimize their own tyranny.

Nine Years Remaining: Defying the Matrix

I stand at thirty-one, stripped bare of all these systems. I disavow them, and they disavow me. Non-conformity is no vanity I flaunt; it is an agonizing reality I inhabit daily. Observing the strings that manipulate the marionettes incapacitates one from enjoying the spectacle.

I shall not survive until forty. I shall perish before it—not because my biology will disintegrate, but because the ultimatum is resolved: either I capitulate, lower my head, fasten the mask, and negotiate terms with 'The System' until whatever remains of my humanity suffocates.. or I endure in this existential insurrection, resisting every current until I burn and dissipate with honor. In either outcome, the man who carries my name today, whose heart beats with truth and defiance, will cease to exist in nine years.

Ink of Certainty: From Parting Hardship to Serenity

By: Midaan Voice • Psychological & Narrative Study • October 2026

The drafting of a final will stands as one of the most agonizing and profound encounters of human existence; it is the exact instant wherein mortality is confronted unvarnished, attempting to compress an entire biography—its passions, doubts, and bonds—into brief lines. It is a written acknowledgment of farewell, a vulnerable endeavor to span a linguistic bridge across two realms.

Yet when studying the testaments of Palestinian martyrs, one encounters a remarkable psychological phenomenon: how does this crushing existential burden metamorphose into absolute composure, serenity, and inward peace?

The Hardship of the Threshold: Confronting Ink and the Void

The immense gravity of composing a will originates in demanding unconditional detachment from biological self-preservation. Human psychology naturally defers contemplation of mortality to sustain daily function. Thus, when an individual grips the pen to inscribe final words, that protective defense collapses, engraving a definitive boundary between 'the now' and 'the beyond'.

Here, ordinary individuals experience disquiet: What remains behind? How shall memory treat me? Have I honored my vows? It is a confrontation with uncertainty. As the martyr-intellectual Basil al-Araj phrased it with raw candor: *"How difficult it is to write your own testament"*, illuminating the philosophical hesitation preceding parting reflections.

> "How difficult it is to write your own testament.. the philosophical hesitation that precedes parting before burden turns to certainty."

Psychological Sublimation: Serenity from Mortal Peril

Notwithstanding the initial threshold, the final testaments reveal a startling psychological transformation surpassing standard existential agitation. This metamorphosis unfolds across three foundational dimensions:

1. Resolving the Labyrinth and Attaining Certainty: Uncertainty is the supreme source of psychic anxiety. The martyr, having embraced their trajectory, has definitively answered life's heaviest questions. When Basil al-Araj declared: *"I march toward my end content, convinced, having found my answers"*, he proclaimed an inward dawn born of seamless synthesis between ethics and action.

2. Transcending the Ego and Merging into the Cause: Modern psychoanalysis frequently correlates thanatophobia with terror over ego extinction. Yet the martyr undergoes profound sublimation, perceiving the self not as frail biological matter, but as an enduring vehicle for higher ideals—liberation, dignity, and homelands. When individual ego dissolves into the collective 'we', death loses its paralyzing potency and transforms from catastrophe into collective renewal, evidenced in Oday al-Tamimi's declaration that his mission was to stir hundreds of youths to shoulder the vanguard after him.

3. Inverting the Calculus of Fear through Direct Engagement: Battlefield testaments (such as the voice dispatches of Ibrahim al-Nabulsi or Wadee al-Hawah) exhibit vocal frequencies devoid of hesitation. Direct forward confrontation releases physiological resolve combined with spiritual conviction that expels dread. Refusing passive demise, the martyr advances autonomously, seizing destiny and securing psychological mastery over besieging forces.

The Psychological Resonance: Bequeathing the Inquest to the Living

Ultimately, the martyr's testament evolves from personal eulogy into an intellectual catalyst directed at the living. Having attained tranquility, the author lays down the instrument, departing while casting existential interrogations upon those left behind. The subtext is clear: "I have arrived at my certainty and stilled my heart; what will you do now?".

The composure radiating from these words is no temporary emotional impulse, but distilled consciousness and radical peace. They demonstrate that when the pen is submerged into the ink of certainty, it possesses the virtue to overcome mortality, transmuting life's most formidable composition into a charter of transcendence and calm.

Register of Palestinian Martyrs' Wills

Compiled by: Midaan Archival Research • Immortal National Ledger • October 2026

An intellectual and historical archive cataloging foundational testaments of Palestinian martyrs that defined watershed epochs in collective awareness, oscillating between deep ideological grounding and spontaneous combat messages under fire.

Synoptic Index of Documented Testaments

Martyr	Year	Classification
Basil al-Araj	2017	Revolutionary intellectual & cultural theory
Baha Alyan	2015	The Ten Commandments (Social & civic)
Dalal al-Mughrabi	1978	Strategic political & military imperative
Tamer al-Kilani	2022	Organizational discipline & spiritual resolve
Ibrahim al-Nabulsi	2022	Field audio dispatch under siege
Oday al-Tamimi	2022	Field manuscript during active manhunt
Yahya Ayyash	1996	Strategic doctrine & combat methodology
Wadee al-Hawah	2022	Tactical transmission via military radio
Ghassan Kanafani	1972	Distilled philosophical & literary paradigms

Part One: Intellectual and Political Testaments

1. Testament of Intellectual Martyr Basil al-Araj (2017):

"Greetings of Arab dignity, homeland, and liberation. To proceed: If you are reading this, it signifies that I have passed away, and my spirit has ascended to its Creator. I pray to meet God with a sound heart, advancing never retreating, in pure sincerity devoid of vanity.

How burdensome it is to write one's own testament. For long years I contemplated the wills of all martyrs; their brevity always astonished me: concise, purposeful, without superfluity. Why do we compose our wills? Do we write them to illuminate a path for those who follow, or do we write them as personal epics, or as declarations of absolution from sins left in our wake?

I march toward my end content and convinced, having uncovered my answers. Woe unto me, how foolish was I—could anything prove more eloquent or articulate than the deed of the martyr? I ought to have written this months ago, yet what stayed my hand was knowing that this is an inquiry that belongs to you, the living. Why should I answer on your behalf? Seek for yourselves; as for us in the chambers of the grave, we seek nothing save the mercy of God."

2. The Ten Wills of Martyr Baha Alyan (2015):

• I bid the factions not to adopt my martyrdom; my death was for the homeland, never for your apparatus.

• I forbid the printing of commemorative posters; your collective memory is too frail to preserve them, and the walls too grim to be adorned.

• I urge my family not to mourn, but to ululate with pride; weep not over me, but weep over your own state.

• I command journalists not to photograph my corpse; such imagery wounds my mother.

• I demand that no partisan insignia or factional acronym be inscribed upon my resting place; let it read simply: Here lies the martyr Baha Alyan.

3. Testament of Martyr Dalal al-Mughrabi (1978):

"My testament to all of you, comrades bearing arms: continue the struggle without pause. I beseech you to unite in a single line, directing your rifles exclusively toward the Zionist adversary. Sovereign Palestinian destiny can never be realized except through an independent rifle."

4. Testament of Martyr Tamer al-Kilani (2022):

"I enjoin you not to shed tears over me, but to rejoice with honor. I prohibit the circulation of any unmasked portrait of mine, lest my legacy be misconstrued as vanity. And I request that the blade hanging in my room be placed upon my grave."

Part Two: Battlefield Testaments Under Fire

5. Message of Martyr Ibrahim al-Nabulsi (2022):

"I have attained martyrdom, my people.. I love my mother immensely. By all that you hold sacred, never abandon the rifle. I am besieged and advancing to my end; pray for me."

6. Message of Martyr Oday al-Tamimi (2022):

"I am the fighter Oday al-Tamimi, who carried out the Shuafat operation. I know well that my solitary operation will not liberate Palestine, but I executed it knowing that its primary purpose is to mobilize hundreds of youths to shoulder arms after me."

7. Maxim of Martyr Yahya Ayyash (1996):
"The occupiers possess the capacity to uproot my physical body from Palestine, but they will never succeed in uprooting the idea from the intellect and hearts of the youth. The battle has not concluded, and will never conclude until the occupation is abolished."

8. Message of Martyr Wadee al-Hawah (2022):
"Do not surrender.. strike them from every vantage. Let no fighter discard their weapon. We are projects of martyrdom, comrades; grieve not for our departure. Persevere; there are steadfast men behind you."

Part Three: Literary Testaments Inspired by the Cause

9. Philosophical Vision of Ghassan Kanafani (Distilled Legacy):

• **On Mortality:** "The problem of death is never the concern of the deceased.. it is the excruciating burden of those left behind, bitterly awaiting their turn."

• **On Complicity and Silence:** "Why did you not pound on the walls of the tanker? Why did you remain silent? Why?"

• **On Gaza and the Soil:** "No, my friend, I shall never come to you in exile.. I shall remain here and never depart. I discover my true self in Gaza; these dossiers kneaded with blood are the solitary things that grant existence meaning."

> "Documenting these wills within Midaan Magazine is our continuing pledge: that narrative is never vanquished, and witness words endure forever."